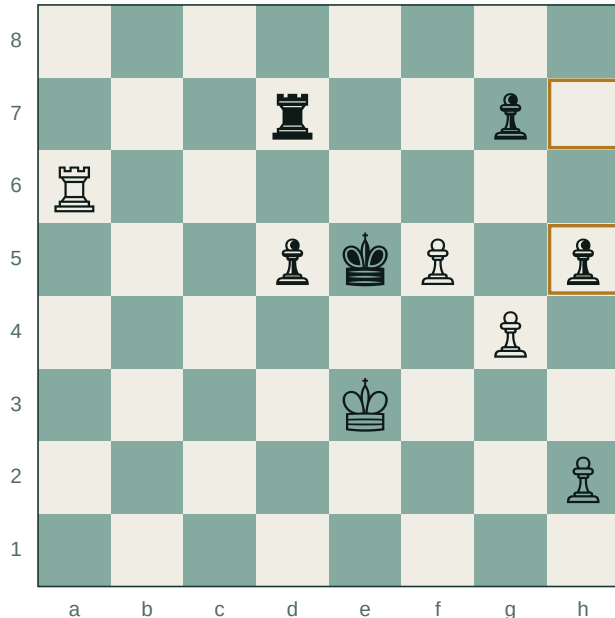


# Rook-ending tactics: White, move 43

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 42...h5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 43. Re6#

**43.Re6#** Mate: rook on e6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

### HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on e5. Geometrically undefended: rook on d7. Check for tactical protection.